

Procedural Sedation Discharge Instructions

You were given medication to help you relax, reduce pain, and/or make you sleepy during your procedure in the Emergency Department.

These medications can continue to affect your thinking, coordination, balance, and reaction time for up to 24 hours — even if you feel mostly normal.

For the Next 24 Hours

DO NOT:

- Drive any vehicle
 - Ride a bicycle, motorcycle, scooter, or e-bike
 - Operate machinery or power tools
 - Drink alcohol
 - Use cannabis or recreational drugs
 - Take sleeping pills or sedating medications unless instructed by your doctor
 - Make important medical, legal, or financial decisions
 - Sign important paperwork or legal documents
 - Cook alone or do potentially dangerous activities
 - Climb ladders or work at heights
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Going Home

- You must have a responsible adult drive you home
- Rest for the remainder of the day
- Move carefully and slowly, as dizziness and poor balance are common
- Use caution when walking or using stairs. Your balance, coordination, and judgment may still be impaired for up to 24 hours
- Start with clear fluids or a light meal before eating heavier foods
- Drink plenty of fluids

If possible, have a responsible adult stay with you for the next several hours.

Driving

Do NOT drive for 24 hours after sedation.

Sedation medications may slow your reaction time and impair judgment even if you feel awake and alert.

This applies to:

- Cars
 - Motorcycles
 - Bicycles and e-bikes
 - Boats
 - Work vehicles
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Seek Medical Attention Immediately If You Have:

- Trouble breathing
 - Chest pain
 - Severe or worsening pain
 - Repeated vomiting
 - Fever
 - Bleeding or significant swelling
 - Confusion or unusual behaviour
 - Difficulty waking up
 - Fainting or seizure activity
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Follow-Up

Follow any additional instructions given for your injury or procedure.

Take medications only as directed.

If you have worsening symptoms or concerns, contact your healthcare provider or return to the Emergency Department.